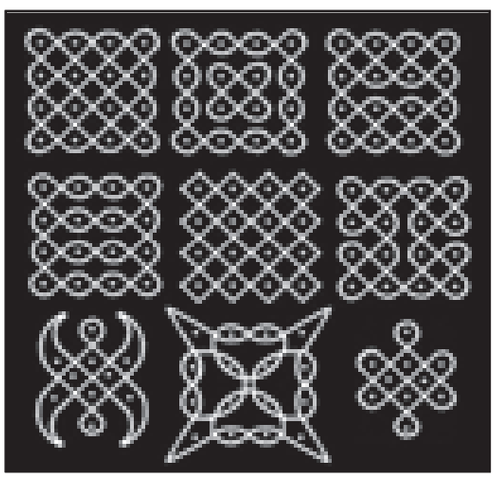
5.9 Floor Decorations

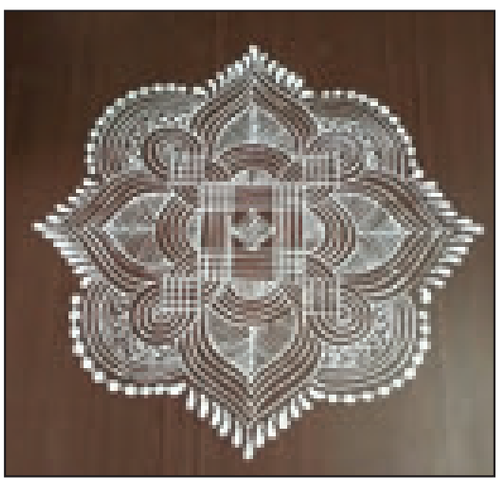
Floor decorations are essential part of the rich heritage of Indian culture and imparts colour, joy, and happiness. The various types of floor decorations are:

- **Kolam:** Kolam is a free hand drawing of various designs. It can be either dotted or in various designs. For drawing kolams, either white stone or chalk powder, enamel paint, white or coloured salt, sand or powders and solutions prepared by mixing rice flour and water is used. Red mud solution is used as painting to give added brightness. In rural areas, people spray cow dung mixed with water as base on floors before putting Kolam.
- **Rangoli:** Coloured dry powder which are usually made from kolam powders are used. They are mixed with either sand or salt.
- **Alpana:** Alpana is a traditional art where the design is painted with white paint. Usually zinc oxide and gum are mixed to keep it for a longer duration.
- **Flower Carpet:** Different coloured flowers, petals and leaves are arranged over the design. Wet sand may be evenly spread beneath the flower carpet to have a raised effect.

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